

GENDER

Priyanka Mahajan Vs. Omkar Sherade



The Google home page is, of course, what appears when you type in "www.google.com", but not everyone knows (or cares) that you can personalise it by adding "gadgets" after signing in using your Google or Gmail ID. The gadgets range from finance to news to jokes to... We got Omkar and Priyanka going to personalise their Google homepages, with

BENDERS

Unsure of the task she was, Priyanka, didn't ask for help. She found the Personalize link soon enough; entering "Add

Stuff", she went on to add Gmail, a world clock, a calendar, free text messaging, and "About C/C++" from under "Popular Add-ons". Under News, Priyanka selected IndiaTimes Cricket, and Translate from under Tools. Searching for an Orkut gadget, she added Yahoo! Mail—she couldn't locate Orkut. Browsing through Finance and Sports, she selected Download.com, Music under Lifestyle, and WordPreference.com from Tools. Searching through all the sections again for Orkut, she finally selected GTalk to compensate for Orkut. Rearranging her home page, she brought Yahoo! Mail, Google Talk and Cricket to the top. A rather social person, we surmise, and the cricket bit was somewhat of a surprise.



Omkar wasn't sure how to do the personalisation, but didn't ask for help either. He dashed to Google, where he found the "Personalize this page" link. From under "Popular Add-ons", he chose BBC News, HowStuffWorks, and Google Video. Finance interested Omkar—he went through each and every page of that section—but he didn't get what he wanted. Under Sports, he selected Soccer Way, and Babelfish (the translator) from under Communications. As we'd sort of expected, he browsed through all the pages under Technology, but he next selected Automotive News under "Lifestyle".

Clicking back to the homepage, Omkar didn't feel the layout was to his taste. Some dragging and dropping later, he rearranged the page. The top news stories, automotive news, and Wikipedia now occupied the top slots in his new homepage. Pretty staid.

personal information on them. Google computers also scan through your mail to see what it is you like / dislike, and target you with more relevant advertisements.

3. **Calendar:** If you use Google calendar, they know what you're doing and when.
4. **Docs and Spreadsheets:** With the growing popularity of Google Docs, Google now has access to what you're creating, and what work you do.
5. **Reader:** If you use their services, Google knows what kind of news interests you, and thus

what kind of products and services you like.

6. **Orkut:** They know who your friends are...
7. **Blogger:** They know what you have to say.
8. **Earth:** They know your address—if you entered it that is...
9. **Toolbar:** They know everything you do online.
10. **Picasa:** They know what you look like.
11. **YouTube:** They know how to entertain you.

First of all, Google doesn't collect personal information from all of its services, we just painted the worst case scenario for

each service above.

Secondly, if you're using all these services like some of us are, does it really matter if they know a little more about you? Thirdly, what's the worst that will happen? Instead of seeing ads on sites that bore you, you might actually be interested in buying something. And finally, you are one of 1.1 billion people online, and with that number growing everyday, do you really think you are that important? It's not like you have your neighbour peering through your bathroom window here... Besides, your chemist knows what health problems you have, your trash man / woman knows what products you use and what you've been eating, your accountant knows how much you earn, your mom knows how much salt you like in your food... Google computers know what you do online, and try to entice you to spend a little money.

We need to all take a step back and relax—until Google starts asking for your bank account details, you have nothing to fear!

THE TECH WAY

A New Way To Grieve

The Virginia Tech tragedy has raised a lot of questions for US politicians, college authorities, and the gun laws across the states. People across the world

are grieving for the loss of loved ones, acquaintances or just citizens of their country. The incident made us realise how we, as in society, have changed. The Net has truly changed the way we deal with tragedies.

Friends dealt with the tragedy by sending condolence messages to the victims' social networking pages. Facebook seemed to be the popular choice for mourners, and numerous rather large groups were formed to condone the incident. Even as the media was confused, and reports about the number of lives lost varied from 10 to the final count of 33, these groups were being formed. Initially they shared information and updates on the events, and now are a gathering place to share experiences and offer condolences. Some of the victims had Orkut pages where condolences started pouring in.

Instant messengers were used by Virginia Tech students to get in touch with friends and family. Reassurances and news spread via e-mail and IM like wild fire. Even Facebook and MySpace were used to share news and send the "I'm OK" signals. Because mobile networks and phone lines were jammed with frantic calls being made to and from the university, Internet connectivity came to the rescue, and proved that it's a more reliable service in terms of crisis.

Even while the ordeal was underway, the student

Buzzword of the MONTH

Centrino Pro

Intel's new, fourth-generation Centrino platform, scheduled for release this month, is the Centrino Pro. It unifies the Santa Rosa platform and their vPro technologies.

This new platform uses the second-generation Intel Core 2 ("Merom") processor, which has an 800 MBps Front Side Bus, capable of switching to 400 MBps *on the fly*. This means the processor will consume lesser power when not in use, thus extending battery life on

laptops and other portable devices. The Centrino Pro also supports the latest 802.11n Wi-Fi specification, which increases range up to 50 metres and has a maximum data transfer rate of 540Mbps. Another important advancement is the inclusion of the Extensible Firmware Interface, which completely replaces the now-ageing BIOS. The Centrino Pro also supports NAND Flash memory caching, which will make for an almost-instant bootup!